

UNIT
51

WORKPLACE SKILLS

CONVERSATION

Team Lead (Marta): Alright, team, quick question. When you scroll through LinkedIn, what skills keep popping up over and over?

Jonas: Leadership. For sure.

Carla: And teamwork — it's literally on every profile.

Marta: Exactly. Leadership, teamwork, problem-solving, resilience, strategic thinking, decision-making. Sometimes it feels unrealistic, like everyone magically has them all.

Nina: Yeah, it's almost copy-paste.

Marta: True. But here's the real question: are these skills actually important at work?

Carla: Totally. Problem-solving — we use it every single day.

Jonas: And resilience. Remember last month when our project got delayed? We had to adapt fast.

Marta: Right. And teamwork is what keeps us moving forward when things get tough. So let's flip it back to you: which of these do you feel strongest in, and which ones do you want to level up?

Nina: Teamwork comes naturally, but decision-making under pressure is tough for me.

Jonas: I'm pretty resilient, but I'd love to get better at strategic thinking.

Carla: Problem-solving's my thing, but I know I could build more resilience.

Marta: Perfect examples. No one has all of these at the highest level — that's okay. The important thing is recognizing your strengths and where you can grow.

Marta: So next time you see those skills listed on LinkedIn, don't just brush them off as buzzwords. You'd better think about how they show up in your work. And you'll want to reflect on which skills you're strong in and which ones you want to grow. Maybe even pick one to focus on this week — small steps make a big difference.



VOCABULARY



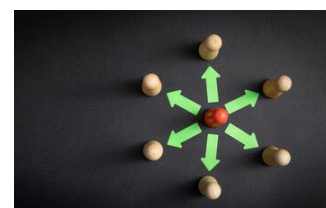
Networking



Leadership



Resilience



Delegation



Teamwork



Strategic thinking



Problem-solving



Decision-
making

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Advising

I'm willing to handle more projects on my own.

You **'d better** develop your problem-solving and decision-making skills first.

I'm looking forward to a lead position.

So, you'll **want** to up your teamwork and leadership game.

UNIT 51



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EXERCISE 1

Complete each sentence with “You’d better” or “You’ll want to” and the correct skill.

- A. _____ You’d better _____ practice _____ teamwork _____ to improve collaboration on the next project.
- B. _____ work on _____ to guide your team more effectively.
- C. _____ develop _____ to handle challenges that come up.
- D. _____ strengthen _____ to stay calm under pressure.
- E. _____ start _____ to build better professional connections.

EXERCISE 2

Rewrite the following advice using you’d better or you’ll want to. Keep the skill in the sentence.

- A. Practice teamwork before leading a project. → _____ you’ll want to practice teamwork before leading a project. _____
- B. Solve problems efficiently before taking bigger tasks. → _____

- C. Focus on staying strong under pressure. → _____

- D. Plan your decisions carefully. → _____

- E. Build connections with colleagues and other teams. → _____

SUMMARY

Structure	Use	Example
You'll want to + verb	Softer advice, suggestion, sounds encouraging.	<i>You'll want to practice teamwork before leading a project.</i>
You'd better + verb	Stronger advice, warning, implies a consequence if not followed.	<i>You'd better solve problems efficiently before taking bigger tasks.</i>

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. You'll want to / You'd better – teamwork
- B. You'll want to / You'd better – leadership
- C. You'll want to / You'd better – problem-solving
- D. You'll want to / You'd better – resilience
- E. You'll want to / You'd better – networking

Exercise 2

- A. You'll want to / You'd better practice teamwork before leading a project.
- B. You'll want to / You'd better solve problems efficiently before taking bigger tasks.
- C. You'll want to / You'd better focus on staying strong under pressure.
- D. You'll want to / You'd better plan your decisions carefully.
- E. You'll want to / You'd better build connections with colleagues and other teams.